



THE ADVENTURER'S GUILD

CODE OF CONDUCT

Charter of Conduct, Professional Obligation, and Guild Discipline

Issued under the seal of the Guild Council and binding upon every sworn member, officer, contractor, apprentice, and licensed company operating under the Guild's name.

THE FIVE BONDS OF GUILD SERVICE



HONOR



FELLOWSHIP



COMMITMENT



SAFE MAGIC



LAWFUL SERVICE

GUILD MAXIM *A guild badge is not a shield against consequence. It is a promise that the bearer will answer for every deed done beneath it.*

Ratified for use in all chartered halls and recognized territories

Copy maintained by the Hallmaster and the Office of Records



Preamble

The Adventurer's Guild exists because danger rarely respects borders, rank, wealth, or preparation. Our members are entrusted with arms, magic, knowledge, and authority beyond that held by most travelers. That trust must be earned each day. This Code establishes the conduct expected of all who wear the Guild badge, accept Guild contracts, use Guild resources, or speak in the Guild's name.

No rule can describe every peril or moral choice. When the written Code does not provide a clear answer, members shall act with restraint, preserve life where reasonably possible, protect those unable to protect themselves, and choose the course they could defend openly before their companions, the client, the local authority, and the Guild Council.

Authority and Application

- A. Binding Effect** — This Code is a condition of membership. Ignorance of its provisions is not a defense once a member has taken the Guild Oath or accepted a Guild-issued badge, writ, license, or contract.
- B. Who Is Covered** — The Code applies to recruits, sworn adventurers, specialists, officers, chapter staff, attached hirelings, and independent companies while operating under Guild charter. A party leader is responsible for ensuring that non-member hirelings receive the rules relevant to their assignment.
- C. Where It Applies** — The Code governs conduct in Guild halls, during travel to and from assignments, while performing a contract, when using Guild property or identification, and whenever a reasonable observer would believe a member acts on the Guild's behalf.
- D. Higher Duties** — Nothing in this Code excuses a member from a lawful oath, professional discipline, military commission, temple vow, or local law. When duties conflict, the member shall pause when possible and seek a ruling from the Questmaster, Hallmaster, or Guild Council.

Terms Used in This Code

- ◆ "Member" means any person recognized by the Guild as a recruit, sworn adventurer, officer, specialist, or chartered associate.
- ◆ "Quest" or "contract" means any assignment entered in the Guild ledger, sealed by an authorized officer, or accepted under emergency field authority.
- ◆ "Civilian" means a person not willingly participating in the hazard, conflict, expedition, or criminal activity at issue.
- ◆ "Restricted art" means magic or alchemy involving domination, curses, uncontrolled summoning, creation of undead, soul manipulation, contagious transformation, planar breach, or any practice designated by the Guild Arcanist.
- ◆ "Reasonable force" means the least force a trained member could reasonably expect to end the immediate threat without creating a greater danger.

ARTICLE I Honor the Guild

Every member carries the reputation of those who came before and those who will follow. Honor is not ceremony; it is reliability under pressure, candor when mistakes occur, and restraint when power could be abused.

- 1.1. Truthful Representation** — Members shall not knowingly lie about rank, authority, training, completed quests, casualties, recovered property, magical capability, or the terms of a contract. Tactical deception against a hostile force may be permitted, but falsifying Guild records never is.
- 1.2. Use of the Guild Name** — The badge, seal, uniform, writ, and reputation of the Guild shall not be used to obtain unlawful entry, avoid lawful fees, intimidate merchants, influence private disputes, secure romantic or financial favor, or claim privileges not expressly granted.



- 1.3. Promises and Agreements** — A member shall honor lawful bargains made for the completion of a quest. Changes to price, scope, or conditions must be recorded and communicated as soon as circumstances permit.
- 1.4. Candor After Error** — A member who causes unintended harm, loses entrusted property, misjudges a threat, or violates procedure shall report the matter promptly. Concealment, destruction of records, coercion of witnesses, or alteration of evidence is a separate and more serious offense.
- 1.5. No Criminal Enterprise** — Members shall not traffic in persons, stolen goods, forbidden relics, poisons intended for indiscriminate use, or information obtained through Guild service. The Guild shall not be used as cover for banditry, assassination, extortion, smuggling, or private war.
- 1.6. Conflicts of Interest** — A member shall disclose family, financial, political, religious, or factional interests that could reasonably affect a contract. The Questmaster may reassign the member, require additional oversight, or record the conflict and permit service with conditions.

FIELD STANDARD *When uncertain whether an advantage is a Guild privilege or an abuse of status, assume it is an abuse until an officer rules otherwise.*

ARTICLE II Respect Fellow Adventurers

The Guild is a fellowship of people whose lives may depend on one another without warning. Members need not share beliefs, customs, homelands, species, magic, or temperament. They must nevertheless provide one another dignity, honest warning, and professional cooperation.

- 2.1. Mutual Aid** — Members shall provide reasonable assistance to companions in immediate danger. No one is required to make a senseless sacrifice, but a member may not abandon a wounded companion merely to protect treasure, reputation, or convenience.
- 2.2. Harassment and Discrimination** — Threats, humiliation, coercion, unwanted sexual conduct, discriminatory treatment, and targeted ridicule based on ancestry, species, sex, identity, origin, disability, faith, magic affinity, lawful faction, or social station are prohibited.
- 2.3. Violence Between Members** — Brawling, dueling, spellcasting, poisoning, or deliberate injury between members is forbidden except in a sanctioned training exercise, lawful defense, or formally witnessed duel conducted under chapter rules. Intoxication is not a defense.
- 2.4. Property and Provisions** — Members shall not steal from companions, tamper with equipment, conceal shared supplies, misappropriate party funds, or claim communal treasure contrary to the recorded agreement. Necessary emergency use must be disclosed afterward.
- 2.5. Sabotage and Betrayal** — Knowingly exposing a party's route, weaknesses, plans, identities, or clients to a hostile actor is a grave offense. So is intentionally interfering with another party's quest for profit, rivalry, or revenge.
- 2.6. Leadership and Dissent** — Party leaders shall hear material safety concerns. Members shall follow lawful field commands but may refuse an order that is manifestly unlawful, suicidal without necessity, or directed toward cruelty, exploitation, or concealment of misconduct. The refusal must be reported when safe.
- 2.7. Care of Recruits** — Experienced members shall not use recruits as disposable scouts, trap-testers, magical subjects, decoys, or servants. Training may involve danger only when the risk is explained, proportionate, supervised, and appropriate to the recruit's rank.



ARTICLE III Complete What You Start

Acceptance of a quest is a public promise. It creates duties to the client, the party, the community placed at risk, and every future member whose work depends upon the Guild's credibility.

- 3.1. Acceptance** — A member shall review the known objective, compensation, hazards, lawful restrictions, reporting requirements, and client identity before accepting a contract. A member shall not accept work they know they are incapable of performing without suitable aid.
- 3.2. No Hoarding or Interference** — Members shall not reserve quests merely to deny them to others, falsify availability, remove postings, threaten competing parties, or manipulate threat classifications for personal advantage.
- 3.3. Duty to Continue** — Members shall make a good-faith effort to complete accepted work. Mere inconvenience, reduced profit, wounded pride, or discovery that another quest is more lucrative does not justify abandonment.
- 3.4. Rightful Withdrawal** — A party may suspend or withdraw when new information makes the quest unlawful, materially different from the posted terms, beyond the party's reasonable capacity, or likely to cause disproportionate civilian harm. The party shall warn affected persons and report to the Questmaster as soon as possible.
- 3.5. Changes in the Field** — Emergency actions beyond the stated contract may be taken to preserve life or prevent immediate catastrophe. Such actions do not automatically entitle the party to additional payment, but the Guild will document the circumstances and negotiate fairly with the client.
- 3.6. Client Property and Evidence** — Recovered property, evidence, remains, prisoners, maps, documents, and relics shall be inventoried. Members may not privately sell, destroy, conceal, or alter items that belong to a client, victim, local authority, or identifiable owner.
- 3.7. Treasure and Salvage** — Treasure division shall follow the party agreement and applicable law. Unclaimed salvage from ruins, lairs, wrecks, and battlefields may be retained only after reasonable inquiry into ownership and after restricted, cursed, historical, or hazardous items are declared.
- 3.8. Quest Report** — Every completed, failed, suspended, or transferred quest requires a timely report stating material events, hazards discovered, persons harmed or rescued, expenses, property recovered, force used, magical incidents, and unresolved risks. Deliberate omission is falsification.

THE PROMISE OF ACCEPTANCE *A quest is not complete when the danger ends. It is complete when the Guild knows what happened, the client receives what is owed, and any remaining danger is plainly recorded.*

ARTICLE IV No Unauthorized Magic or Experimentation

Magic is a tool, a discipline, and in some lands a public fear. Its careless use can injure people who never consented to the risk, damage the Guild's standing, or create hazards that outlive the caster. Skill does not replace authorization.

- 4.1. Consent and Coercion** — Members shall not use enchantment, domination, memory alteration, truth-compulsion, dream intrusion, or similar magic upon another member, client, witness, prisoner, or civilian without lawful authority, informed consent, or an immediate necessity to prevent greater harm.
- 4.2. Restricted Arts** — Necromancy involving sentient remains, curses, soul-binding, possession, uncontrolled summoning, planar breach, contagious transformation, and permanent alteration of mind or body require written approval from the Guild Arcanist or emergency authorization documented afterward.
- 4.3. Guild Facilities** — Alchemy, enchanting, spell research, monster dissection, and relic testing shall occur only in designated spaces using required wards, ventilation, assistants, records, and containment. Sleeping quarters, kitchens, stables, public halls, and rented rooms are not laboratories.



- 4.4. Summoned and Created Beings** — The summoner or creator is responsible for control, humane treatment, dismissal, containment, and damage caused. A being capable of independent thought shall not be treated as disposable property merely because magic brought it forth.
- 4.5. Curses and Contamination** — A member who suspects exposure to a curse, possession, magical disease, uncontrolled transformation, or hostile influence must report it and comply with reasonable examination or quarantine. Concealment that endangers others is a grave offense.
- 4.6. Relics and Unknown Items** — Unknown magical objects shall be handled as hazardous until identified. Members shall not activate, attune to, feed, open, wear, dismantle, sell, or transport a suspected relic through a populated area without suitable precautions.
- 4.7. Field Casting** — Area spells, fire, lightning, poison, structural magic, teleportation, and summoned hazards shall be used with regard for bystanders, flammable materials, buildings, animals, roads, crops, and escape routes. Convenience does not justify indiscriminate effects.
- 4.8. Sanctioned Training** — Magical duels and demonstrations require a designated supervisor, marked boundaries, agreed limitations, healing or countermeasure capability, and immediate termination when a participant yields or safety fails.

ARTICLE V Obey Local Laws

The Guild is influential, but it is not sovereign. Local rulers, courts, councils, temples, and communities retain authority within their lawful reach. Members are expected to understand that laws differ and that a respected reputation is often the Guild's most valuable protection.

- 5.1. Ordinary Compliance** — Members shall obey local rules governing weapons, magic, entry, curfew, hunting, burial, protected creatures, salvage, taxation, controlled substances, and treatment of prisoners unless immediate action is necessary to preserve life.
- 5.2. No Improper Influence** — Members shall not bribe, threaten, enchant, blackmail, impersonate, or falsely invoke Guild authority to alter a lawful decision. Customary fees and properly recorded facilitation payments are permitted only where lawful and disclosed.
- 5.3. Arrest and Accusation** — A member arrested, detained, summoned, or formally accused shall identify themselves truthfully, avoid unnecessary resistance, and notify the nearest Guild hall when possible. The Guild may provide an advocate but will not conceal a member from justified process.
- 5.4. Unjust or Corrupt Orders** — A member is not required to obey an order that demands slavery, torture, massacre, persecution, fabricated evidence, theft from innocents, or another manifest injustice. The member should withdraw, preserve evidence, protect endangered persons when feasible, and report to Guild leadership.
- 5.5. Conflicting Law and Mission** — When local law conflicts with a Guild contract or urgent public safety, the party shall seek clarification before acting. If delay would likely cause death or catastrophe, the party may act according to necessity and must later provide a full accounting.
- 5.6. Political Neutrality of Service** — Members may hold personal loyalties, but shall not commit the Guild to a war, rebellion, succession dispute, trade conflict, or factional cause without Council authority. A private political act must not be represented as Guild policy.
- 5.7. Foreign Custom** — Members traveling abroad shall make reasonable efforts to learn local customs concerning sacred sites, burial, hospitality, dress, names, animals, magic, and authority. Honest error may be forgiven; contemptuous disregard will not be.



Standing Duties of Every Member

The following duties apply across all five Articles and are expected even when they do not appear in a particular quest posting.

- S.1. Protection of Innocents** — Avoid unnecessary harm to civilians, captives, animals, homes, crops, wells, roads, and places of worship. A member who creates a foreseeable danger must take reasonable steps to warn, evacuate, contain, or repair.
- S.2. Proportionate Force** — Use force to stop a threat, not to punish an enemy. Once a person surrenders or is no longer a threat, killing, torture, mutilation, humiliation, or deliberate neglect is forbidden except where an immediate magical danger cannot otherwise be contained.
- S.3. Treatment of Prisoners** — Disarm, search, separate, guard, and provide basic care consistent with safety. Prisoners shall be delivered to lawful authority or managed according to the contract. Summary execution for convenience is prohibited.
- S.4. Aid After Conflict** — When safely possible, provide or summon reasonable aid for wounded allies, civilians, and defeated foes. A member is not required to exhaust rare resources, but may not deny simple aid out of spite.
- S.5. Confidentiality** — Protect client information, witness identities, routes, passwords, warding methods, personnel records, and Guild intelligence. Disclosure is permitted when necessary to prevent imminent harm, comply with lawful process, or report misconduct.
- S.6. Readiness** — Maintain equipment, licenses, spell records, required training, and physical condition appropriate to accepted work. Intoxication, exhaustion, or impairment shall be disclosed when it materially affects safety.
- S.7. Duty to Report** — Report deaths, disappearances, serious injuries, civilian harm, major property damage, restricted magic, lost Guild property, discovered corruption, suspected betrayal, and unresolved hazards without unreasonable delay.
- S.8. Duty to Cooperate** — Members shall cooperate honestly with authorized Guild reviews. Cooperation does not require confession to a crime without counsel, but destruction of evidence, witness intimidation, collusion, or retaliation is prohibited.

Immediate Reportable Incidents

- ◆ Death, disappearance, petrification, possession, or incapacitation of a party member, client, prisoner, or civilian connected to a quest.
- ◆ Use of lethal force against a person who was not actively attacking at the time force was used.
- ◆ Activation, loss, theft, or breach of a cursed, sentient, planar, royal, divine, or otherwise restricted item.
- ◆ Uncontrolled summoning, undead creation, magical contamination, spreading transformation, or unexplained loss of memory or will.
- ◆ Arrest, declaration of outlawry, formal complaint by a ruler or magistrate, or demand for extradition of a Guild member.
- ◆ Loss of Guild seals, badges, teleportation keys, restricted maps, client records, evidence, funds, or weapons held in trust.
- ◆ Reasonable suspicion that a member or officer is betraying a party, falsifying records, taking bribes, or using the Guild for criminal purposes.

Discipline and Adjudication

Discipline exists to protect the public, preserve the Guild's trust, correct conduct where possible, and remove members who cannot safely be entrusted with Guild authority. It is not intended as private revenge or political convenience.

Making a Complaint

- D.1. Who May Report** — A complaint may be made by a member, client, witness, local authority, chapter employee, or affected civilian. Anonymous reports may be considered when they contain verifiable detail, though anonymity can limit the Guild's ability to act.



D.2. Where to Report — Complaints may be delivered to the Hallmaster, Questmaster, Guild Advocate, chapter records office, or any officer not personally involved. A complaint against a Hallmaster goes directly to the regional office or Guild Council.

D.3. Protection from Retaliation — No member may threaten, demote, exclude, blacklist, expose, or otherwise punish a person for making a good-faith report or participating honestly in a review. Knowingly false accusations remain subject to discipline.

Review Procedure

D.4. Initial Safety Action — An officer may temporarily remove a member from active quests, secure dangerous property, restrict facility access, or require medical or magical examination when immediate risk exists. This is protective, not a finding of guilt.

D.5. Notice — The member shall receive a plain statement of the alleged conduct, the Articles involved, any temporary restrictions, and the officer responsible for the review, unless delay is necessary to protect a witness or prevent destruction of evidence.

D.6. Inquiry — The reviewing officer may gather reports, ledgers, magical records, witness statements, physical evidence, and local findings. Compelled magical examination of mind, memory, or soul requires consent or Council-level authority under applicable law.

D.7. Response — The member shall have a fair opportunity to answer the allegation, identify witnesses, explain circumstances, and present relevant evidence. The member may request a Guild Advocate or trusted representative.

D.8. Decision — Minor matters may be decided by the Hallmaster. Grave matters, expulsion, permanent blacklisting, or a Guild bounty require a tribunal of at least three authorized officers, none of whom may be the complainant or materially interested.

D.9. Written Record — The result, findings, sanction, duration, conditions, and appeal rights shall be entered into the disciplinary ledger. Sealed details may be protected, but the existence of a restriction may be shared with those who need to enforce it.

Schedule of Sanctions

Grade	Finding	Typical Examples	Available Measures
I	Minor Breach	Late report, discourtesy, negligent paperwork, first low-risk facility violation.	Counseling, verbal warning, correction, retraining, apology, restitution.
II	Serious Breach	Quest abandonment without proper notice, reckless conduct, misuse of badge, harassment, unsafe magic without injury.	Written reprimand, fine, restitution, probation, temporary quest restriction, loss of facility privileges.
III	Grave Breach	Theft from a member or client, deliberate falsification, serious civilian harm, restricted magic, retaliation, repeated serious offenses.	Suspension, rank reduction, relic or badge surrender, supervised service, extended prohibition from quests, public notice to chapters.
IV	Dishonorable Conduct	Betrayal, torture, trafficking, murder, intentional catastrophic magic, major corruption, sabotage of Guild operations.	Expulsion, permanent blacklist, referral to authorities, seizure of Guild-issued property, loss of charter and honors.
V	Hostile Offender	An expelled member actively attacks the Guild or innocents, steals dangerous Guild assets, or continues conduct posing an	Protective warrant or formal bounty authorized by the Guild Council, specifying capture terms, lawful



Grade	Finding	Typical Examples	Available Measures
		extraordinary threat.	jurisdiction, and limits on force.

Sanctions are selected according to intent, harm, risk, repetition, honesty after the event, cooperation, abuse of rank, and efforts to repair the damage. A severe result does not require every lower sanction to be imposed first.

Restitution, Service, and Conditions

- ◆ Restitution may include payment, repair, return of property, replacement of supplies, healing costs, funeral expenses, or compensation negotiated through the Guild.
- ◆ Corrective service may include training, supervised quests, public-safety work, records duty, mentoring restrictions, or temporary reassignment away from vulnerable clients or restricted magic.
- ◆ A suspended or expelled member shall return Guild badges, keys, seals, restricted records, issued equipment, and any item held solely by virtue of office or membership.
- ◆ No sanction may require torture, humiliation, slavery, compelled romantic or sexual service, dangerous experimentation, or an unlawful act.

Appeal and Restoration

- A.1. Right of Appeal** — A member may appeal a Grade II or higher sanction within thirty days of receiving the written decision, or later upon newly discovered evidence. The appeal shall identify the claimed error, new evidence, disproportionate sanction, or conflict of interest.
- A.2. Reviewing Authority** — An appeal is heard by an officer or tribunal not involved in the original decision. The reviewing authority may affirm, reduce, increase, suspend, or return the matter for further inquiry, but shall provide reasons.
- A.3. Reinstatement** — A former member may petition for reinstatement when the expulsion was not permanent and the conditions of return have been met. The Council shall consider restitution, elapsed time, conduct since expulsion, risk to the public, and testimony from affected persons.
- A.4. Restoration of Honor** — Completion of discipline does not erase the record, but a member who accepts responsibility and demonstrates lasting reform may receive a formal restoration entry. The Guild believes that accountability and redemption can exist together.

The Field Test

Before taking an uncertain action under Guild authority, a member should be able to answer each question plainly. A “no” does not always forbid action in an emergency, but it signals the need for restraint, consultation, or immediate reporting.

AUTHORITY	Do I have lawful or contractual authority to do this?
NECESSITY	Is the action necessary, or merely faster, easier, or more profitable?
PROPORTION	Is the likely harm proportionate to the danger being prevented?
CONSENT	Am I overriding another person's will, body, memory, property, or safety without adequate cause?



COMPANIONS	Have I warned or consulted those whose lives depend on the decision?
RECORD	Would I describe this action truthfully in the quest report?
HONOR	Could I defend this choice before the harmed person, the Guild Council, and my own companions?
RULE OF LAST RESORT <i>If an action cannot survive truthful reporting, it should not be done beneath the Guild badge.</i>	



A member's surest protection is a deed that needs no concealment.



BY WORD AND DEED



MEMBER'S OATH AND ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that the badge of the Adventurer's Guild grants no freedom from consequence. It signifies that I have accepted a greater duty: to act with honor, to protect those placed in my care, to stand beside my companions, to complete my promises faithfully, to practice magic with restraint, and to answer honestly for my deeds.

I have received or been granted access to the Guild Code of Conduct. I understand that this Code applies whenever I use Guild authority, property, contracts, identification, facilities, or reputation. I agree to report serious violations and immediate dangers, to cooperate in fair review, and to accept lawful discipline when my conduct falls below the standard I have sworn to uphold.

“By my word and by my deed, I will bring no needless shame upon the Guild, no needless danger upon my companions, and no needless harm upon the innocent.”

Member Signature

Printed Name or Adventuring Name

Guild Rank and Chapter

Date and Witness

Officer Certification

I certify that the member named above was given a reasonable opportunity to read the Code, ask questions, and understand the reporting and disciplinary provisions before taking the Guild Oath.

Authorizing Officer

Seal, Office, and Date



A COPY OF THIS ACKNOWLEDGMENT SHALL BE ENTERED IN THE MEMBER'S GUILD RECORD.

The Code remains binding whether or not this page is signed, provided membership was knowingly accepted.